

Instructions to Candidates for Assessments and Examinations

1. General Instructions to Candidates

1.1 Academic Honesty

- a. Candidates are required to read and adhere to the [NUS Code of Student Conduct](#).
- b. A breach of any of the NUS Code of Student Conduct or the assessment rules will render a candidate liable to disciplinary action which may result in suspension or expulsion from the University. The online versions of NUS Statute 6 and Regulation 10 can be accessed from the Office of the University Registrar's [website](#).

1.2 Assessment Type

Candidates should note that NUS operates four exam/assessment modes: (i) Closed Book, (ii) Closed Book with Authorised Materials, (iii) Open Book, and (iv) Open Internet. Candidates should become familiar with the particular mode used by their course. If a digital assessment platform is employed (usually ExamSoft/Examplify), candidates should further ensure their laptop/notebook computers are compatible (see Sections 2.2 and 2.3).

1.3 Use of Electronic Calculators

- a. Unless expressly forbidden by the examiner, electronic calculators will be allowed by default for all continual assessments and final exams. Candidates may use any authorised scientific or graphing calculator model from the List of Approved Calculators found [here](#).
- b. Prior to the assessment, candidates are responsible to clear all information and programmes, including formulae and text, that may be stored in the calculator memory.
- c. Candidates are not allowed to use calculators with built-in symbolic algebra manipulations, symbolic differentiation and/or integration. Candidates are also not allowed to use calculators with communication capability with other devices, and/or data storage and retrieval capability for verbal information.
- d. Candidates found with an unauthorised electronic calculator model on their person or in their workspace during the assessment may be deemed to have intent to use that device to gain an unlawful advantage and will be subject to disciplinary proceedings accordingly.

- e. Candidates found to have stored information and programmes in their calculator memory may be deemed to have intent to use the information and programmes to gain an unlawful advantage and will be subject to disciplinary proceedings accordingly

1.4 Unauthorised Materials and Devices

Candidates should check that they do not have on their person nor in their workspace any unauthorised materials, including personal notes, aids and flashcards that may confer an unfair advantage. Candidates should also check that they do not have any unauthorised devices with communication capability that can transmit and/or receive information, whether voice, text or data, to another device or entity, regardless of whether that function is switched on or not. Such devices include mobile phones, smart watches, wireless earphones, AR/VR glasses, audio and image recorders. Unauthorised devices also include calculators and computers if these are not allowed for the assessment or exam.

Such materials and devices have to be kept away on the floor, or preferably in a bag.

Candidates found with unauthorised materials or devices on their person or in their workspace during the assessment may be deemed to have intent to use these materials and devices to gain an unlawful advantage and will be subject to disciplinary proceedings accordingly.

1.5 Ban on Local Large Language Models

Candidates should ensure that no local Large Language Models (LLMs) are installed on their laptop/notebook computers intended for use during digital assessments. Any previously installed LLMs must be completely removed prior to the commencement of the assessment.

Candidates found with a local LLM installed on their laptop/notebook computer used for a digital assessment may be deemed to have intent to use the LLM to gain an unlawful advantage and be subject to disciplinary proceedings accordingly.

1.6 Actions to be Taken if Unwell

Candidates should consult a doctor if they feel unwell. If the candidate is certified medically unfit to sit for the examination, the candidate should apply for Special Consideration via [EduRec](#) and submit by the stipulated [deadline](#) (see section 1.6, Request for Special Consideration).

1.7 Safeguard of Personal Belongings

Candidates are required to place their personal belongings at the designated areas inside the exam venue. Please do not bring any valuable belongings except for those required for the

examination. The University will not be responsible for the loss or damage of any such belongings.

1.8 Request for Special Consideration

If there are any circumstances, academic or otherwise, which have adversely affected a candidate's academic performance during the course of the semester or during the assessments, the candidate may submit such information to the Board of Examiners for consideration.

In general, examples of such circumstances include, but are not limited to the following:

- a. illness during the assessment which results in the candidate not being able to complete the assessment;
- b. illness during an assessment but for which the candidate completes the assessment nevertheless;
- c. death of an immediate family member;
- d. personal problems/crises.

All Special Consideration submissions will be treated in the strictest confidence and must be submitted through [EduRec](#) before the stipulated deadline in the [Examination Directory](#) (for candidates), under General Information – [important deadlines](#) on assessments-related matters. **Late Submissions will not be accepted.**

1.9 Actions to be taken in the event of Fire Alarm

In the event of fire alarm activation during the assessment,

- a. Candidates should remain calm and get ready to evacuate from the venue by the nearest fire exit upon the instruction of the Chief Invigilator.
- b. Candidates should not remove the assessment papers and the answer scripts or stop to collect personal belongings.
- c. Candidates should report at the designated assembly point.
- d. Candidates should not re-enter the exam venue without permission.

2. Preparing for Assessment

2.1 General Preparation

Candidates will be informed by the instructor about the modality of assessment (paper or digital).

2.2 Use of Laptop and Notebook Computers

- a. Unless otherwise indicated by the examiner, candidates are required to bring a reliable laptop, notebook computer or tablet computer for all digital assessments and final exams. Candidates should have administrator rights to the device so that they can install the assessment software. To enhance exam performance, and, more broadly, to experience the full benefits of technology-enhanced learning, candidates should have a device that meets the minimum system requirements and battery life specified [here](#).
- b. Financially needy full-time undergraduate students facing difficulties acquiring such a device should contact the Office of Admissions for assistance. NUS offers a Student Assistance Loan that provides an interest-free top-up to buy a suitable laptop or notebook computer. Please visit [here](#).
- c. For assessments and exams, candidates should have a fully-charged power bank that can last at least three hours. Candidates should not assume that test venues will be able to provide electrical outlets to support their power needs.
- d. Candidates are not allowed to have more than one computer (laptop, notebook computer or tablet) in their workspace at any one time.
- e. Candidates are also not allowed to have extended monitors or dual/extended screens in their workspace.

2.3 Before the Start of the Assessment

For Digital Assessments (Using ExamSoft):

- a. Candidates are required to provide a laptop, notebook, or tablet computer with the correct version of Examplify installed (see [here](#) for details).
- b. Candidates are required to download the encrypted assessment file before the actual assessment, preferably 8 to 12 hours before, when notified by the instructor. Candidates whose assessment paper is in the morning may download the encrypted assessment paper up to 12 hours before the start time, i.e. a 9 am paper may be downloaded from 9 pm the night before. Candidates whose assessment paper is in the afternoon may download the encrypted assessment paper up to 8 hours before the

start time, i.e. a 1 pm paper may be downloaded from 5 am that morning. The password to decrypt the file will be provided at the start of the assessment by the invigilator.

- c. If a candidate were to turn up without the necessary preparations (e.g. without a laptop, notebook, or tablet computer, or without downloading the requisite exam file) the time taken to resolve these issues shall be borne by the candidate.
- d. Candidates should fully charge their laptop, notebook, or tablet computer before the assessment, and bring a fully-charged power bank that can last at least three hours. Candidates should not assume that assessment venues will be able to provide electrical outlets to support their power needs.

2.4 At the Start of the Assessment

- a. Candidates would be allowed into the assessment venue 15 minutes before the scheduled commencement time for both paper and digital assessments.
- b. Candidates **will not** be admitted into the venue after one hour from the start of the assessment.
- c. Candidates are not allowed to leave the venue within the first hour of the assessment, as well as, within the last 15 minutes of the assessment.
- d. Candidates must bring their student card or any other identification document with photograph (e.g., NRIC, passport, driving license, etc.) for identity verification purpose, and place this on the desk.
- e. Candidates should only indicate their student number in their submissions, including answer booklets, and optical mark reader (OMR) form for MCQ. For OMR form, candidates should also shade their student number.
- f. Candidates must not start writing until allowed to do so by the invigilator.

2.5 During the Assessment

- a. Candidates are **not allowed** to communicate with any other person except the invigilators.
- b. Candidates **must not** bring into the venue or take out from the venue, and receive from any person, or access any unauthorised materials e.g. books, papers, information from NUS intranet, internet, or any other materials.
- c. Candidates should raise their hand if they wish to communicate with an invigilator and should not leave their seat without permission.

- d. Candidates must not bring their mobile phone nor any other devices with communication capability with them when they go to the washroom.
- e. Candidates must not remove any answer booklets, assessment reference materials (e.g. statistical tables), and papers, used or unused, from the venue, except their own question paper unless otherwise instructed.
- f. Candidates should not write on, mark, highlight or deface any reference materials.
- g. Candidates should inform the invigilator if they feel unwell.

2.6 At the End of the Assessment

- a. Candidates will not be allowed to leave during the last 15 minutes.
- b. Candidates must stop writing when the invigilator declares the assessment has ended. Candidates who persist in writing will be penalized.
- c. Candidates are responsible for the submission of their answer scripts. If they do not submit their answer scripts, they are deemed to have sat for and failed the assessment.
- d. Candidates should remain seated quietly while the invigilator collects and counts the answer scripts or checks the completion of online submissions. Candidates should leave all used or unused answer booklets and reference materials on the desk.

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